Where You Are: Step Three, Reviewing Mom's Support, and What Comes After It

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap on one page, with yours opened up.

Mom is doing well, and you've started looking at how her week fits together. It helps to see where that sits in the larger picture, and to know there's no clock on any of it.

This page shows all nine steps, where you are among them, and what follows.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

You are here. This is the first of three topics in this step. It's about seeing Mom's support as it is today: who does what, which tasks rest on one person, and which backups have actually been agreed to. You finish it with a written list that keeps what isn't covered today apart from what might come up later, ready for a professional to review.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this step produces

A written list of Mom's support as it stands: what she gets help with, who helps, and the lines where the answer is “only them,” “assumed” or “not sure.” It separates present needs from things that might come up later, and marks which lines the family will talk about now and which it will keep in view. These are the family's own notes, put in order. They aren't a verdict on Mom or on her arrangement.

What happens next

Two more topics finish step three. Care Requirements records what Mom's support has to cover as things stand. Care Roadmap sorts what to organize now and what to keep an eye on. The list you make here is what both of them start from, and together the three produce the step's output: a Care Needs Profile and a Future Action Roadmap. After that comes step four, Explore Options, at whatever pace suits the family.

You'll also come back to this topic. The National Institute on Aging says arrangements for sharing care may need revising over time, as the person's needs and family members' availability change, and suggests checking in regularly with the older person and the other caregivers. So the list gets reread, not finished. [1]

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: listing who does what, asking the people named as backups, and writing down what each one says.
- Mom: her own account of her week, including what she wants help with and what she doesn't. It's her arrangement.
- The people who help her: the neighbor, your brother, anyone the family thinks of as a backup. Each one says what they can really do.
- Her doctor and her other clinicians: any question about her health, and what a change means medically.
- Your care consultant: brings their own observations together with the family interview, looks at where the support Mom needs and the support she has differ, and includes the family's capacity and her quality of life, not only clinical concerns.

A word you may hear

One kind of professional who does work like this is a geriatric care manager. The National Institute on Aging says they work with you to form a care plan and find the services you need. [2]

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available to help, or how things turn out. Families planning ahead take the steps in their own time.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this review sits among the nine steps and what follows it. The care interview is how the step gets its full picture: it goes through each area of Mom's daily life, including the ones that are fine today, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The advice to revise and check in as circumstances change, and the description of a geriatric care manager, are the National Institute on Aging's.

1. National Institute on Aging, Sharing Caregiving Responsibilities

2. National Institute on Aging, Aging in Place: Growing Older at Home